



PROTESTERS gather in front of the “Jimmy Kimmel Live!” theater a day after ABC pulled the show off air. GENARO MOLINA Los Angeles Times

LATE-NIGHT ABSENCE STIRS WORRY IN HOLLYWOOD

Spider-Man and a Hollywood tour guide were having it out.

They stood right outside Jimmy Kimmel’s studio on Hollywood Boulevard, arguing about whether ABC was right to yank the host’s TV show off the air last week after he commented on the political response to right-wing activist Charlie Kirk’s killing.

“I like Kimmel!” said the Spider-Man impersonator, who wore pink Nike sneakers and leaned in close so he could hear through his thin, face-covering costume. “What he said is free speech.”

Todd Doten, a tour agent for Beverly Hills Tours of Hollywood, pushed back. He said he believed broadcasters are held to a different standard than private citizens, and that the Federal Communications Commission — which pushed to get Kimmel’s show canceled — “has somewhat of a point.”

Jimmy Kimmel helped lift the area’s fortunes. Now, locals fear life without him.

By Christopher Buchanan and Hailey Branson-Potts

The men verbally sparred beside singer Little Richard’s cracked star on the Walk of Fame. Then Doten patted the selfie-hawking superhero on the back and they parted ways amicably.

The scene on Friday afternoon captured the Hollywood that Kimmel embraced and aggressively promoted: Weird, gritty and surprisingly poignant.

Ever since he began filming at the El Capitan Entertainment Centre in 2003, Kimmel has been one of the famed neighborhood’s biggest ambassadors. He drew tourists to the storied Hollywood Boulevard, which — despite being home to the Academy Awards, TCL Chinese Theatre and the Walk of Fame — has long struggled with crime, homelessness and blight. He used his celebrity to help homeless youth and opened a donation center on [See Kimmel, A9]

LGBTQ+ candidates find their motivation

‘We can’t sit on the sidelines’: Backsliding on queer rights, other issues spurs activism.

By Kevin Rector

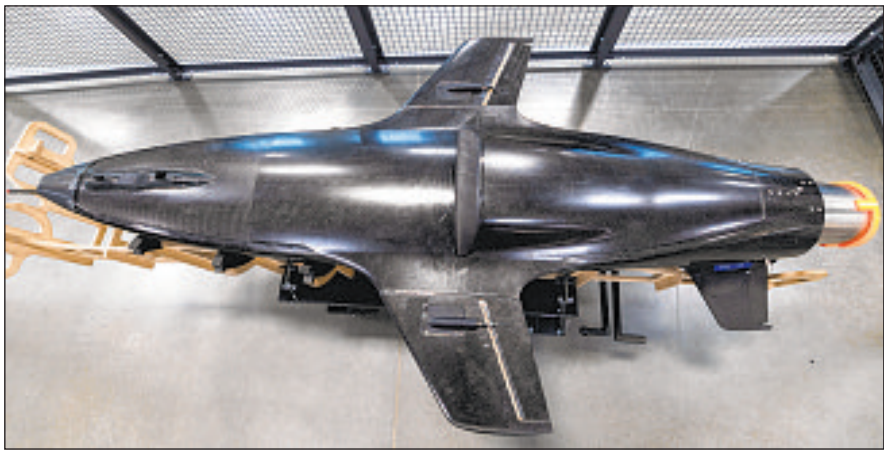
San Diego City Councilmember Marni von Wilpert doesn’t generally agree with political parties redrawing congressional maps to gain power.

But after President Trump persuaded Texas Gov. Greg Abbott to redraw his state’s maps in order to improve Republican chances of retaining control of Congress in 2026, Von Wilpert said she decided California’s only option was to fight back with new maps of its own, favoring Democrats.

There’s too much at stake for LGBTQ+ people and other marginalized Californians to do otherwise, said Von Wilpert — who is bisexual and running to unseat Republican incumbent Rep. Darrell Issa, a Trump ally whose district in San Diego and Riverside counties will be redrawn if voters approve the plan.

“We can’t sit on the sidelines anymore and just hope that the far right will play fair or play by the rulebook,” said Von Wilpert, 42. “If we don’t fight back now, I don’t know what democracy is going to be left for us to fight for in the future.”

Von Wilpert’s challenge to Issa — who did not respond to a request for comment — makes her part of a growing wave of LGBTQ+ candidates running for office at a time when many on the right and in the Trump administration are working aggressively to push queer people out of the American [See LGBTQ+, A7]



HUNTINGTON Beach-based Mach Industries’ concept for a strike aircraft. ALLEN J. SCHABEN Los Angeles Times

Silicon Valley’s pivot to defense lifts L.A. startups

By Laurence Darmiento and Queenie Wong

One weapon being tested can be dropped into the stratosphere thousands of miles from its target and can deliver an explosive with precision even without GPS.

Another is a cruise missile that takes off vertically without a runway so it can deliver a strike from at least 180 miles with the accuracy of a helicopter-launched rocket.

The weapons have drawn plenty of interest not only from the Department of Defense, but also from venture capitalists who are backing their manufacturer — Mach Industries, a Huntington Beach

startup founded by an MIT dropout with big ambitions.

The three-year-old company has received \$185 million in venture funding and last year moved from Texas to Southern California, where it opened a factory to draw on the area’s wealth of aerospace and defense talent.

“If there is a single sort of success criteria for Mach it is the ability to deter a war in the Pacific with China over the next decade, and so I think that calls for massive investment,” said company founder Ethan Thornton, who is just 21. [See Startups, A12]



GINA FERAZZI Los Angeles Times

FOND FAREWELL

Dodgers pitcher Clayton Kershaw (22) receives accolades as he exits his final regular-season start at Dodger Stadium on Friday. **SPORTS, D1**

A few seats will decide the House

Redistricting fights may become moot, columnist Mark Z. Barabak says. **PERSPECTIVES, A2**

Anderson opines on his optimism

Director returns with the angry epic “One Battle After Another.” **ENTERTAINMENT, E4**

Weather
Partly sunny.
L.A. Basin: 84/67. **B10**



Trump imposes \$100,000 fee for H-1B visas

Rules favoring wealthiest foreign workers are a stark shift for U.S.

By Josh Wingrove and Spencer Soper

President Trump has taken his most extensive step yet toward overhauling the U.S. legal migration system, with a pair of proclamations that explicitly favor the wealthiest of the world’s prospective expat workers.

Trump on Friday imposed a \$100,000 application fee on the widely used H-1B visa program, a move that would drastically increase the cost of visas heavily coveted by some of America’s largest companies — including in the Silicon Valley — seeking to bring in skilled workers from abroad.

California has the highest number of H-1B workers, with Apple and Google among the leading recipients in the country. Amazon is by far the top recipient.

The president also unveiled a “Trump Gold Card” visa program — under

India says it is studying measure

The nation expresses fear of “humanitarian consequences” for families there. **NATION, A6**

which, for the price of \$1 million, immigrants could get U.S. residency. Businesses could buy residency permits for \$2 million per employee, while a new “platinum” card set to be issued soon would cost \$5 million and allow the holder to come to the U.S. for up to 270 days a year without being subject to U.S. taxes on non-U.S. income.

The restrictions and fees go into effect Sunday.

It all amounts to a plan for a new gilded age of immigration to America, where those with the resources to invest are welcomed along with their wallets — while at the same time new barriers [See Visas, A8]

Newsom signs bills to protect migrants

‘We’re not North Korea,’ the governor says, while moving to unmask agents as well.

By Matthew Ormseth, Dakota Smith and Laura J. Nelson

In response to the Trump administration’s aggressive immigration raids that have rolled Southern California, Gov. Gavin Newsom on Saturday signed a package of bills aimed at protecting immigrants in schools, hospitals and other areas targeted by federal agents.

He also signed a bill that bans federal agents from

wearing masks, making California the first state to do so.

Speaking at Miguel Contreras Learning Complex in Los Angeles, Newsom said President Trump had turned the country into a “dystopian sci-fi movie” with scenes of masked agents hustling immigrants without legal status into unmarked cars.

“We’re not North Korea,” Newsom said.

Newsom framed the pieces of legislation as pushback against what he called the “secret police” of Trump and Stephen Miller, the White House advisor who has driven the second Trump administration’s [See Newsom, A11]



ETIENNE LAURENT For The Times

VIDIOTS projectionist Jason Moore rewinds a film in the movie theater’s projection booth last week.

Box offices are reeling, but revival cinemas roll

By Anthony Solorzano

A grainy circle flashes on the top-right corner of the screen at the Eagle Theater. The single-screen repertory cinema, run by the nonprofit organization Vidiots, was showing a 35-millimeter print of Paul Thomas Anderson’s psychological drama “The Master.”

The faint warning is easily missed by most viewers, but it appears every 10 minutes, alerting the projectionist to change the reel.

The auditorium was sold out. Audience members clapped as the film title appeared onscreen. There was a buzz in the air even before

the lights faded to black with the standby line filled with hopefuls trying to grab a last-minute ticket. The stakes were high for the person manning the reel exchange.

Michael Rousselet, a projectionist at the Eagle Rock theater, often drinks a lot of coffee to stay alert during late-night screenings.

“If we do a good job, no one knows we exist,” Rousselet quipped as he showed off the projection booth. “If we mess up, everyone knows we exist.”

The carefully curated communal experience offered by repertory theaters is enduring the hardships of [See Theaters, A8]